



Healthy Foods

Requirements

1. Listen to a book about healthy foods.
2. Say three things you learned about healthy foods. (eg. fruits have vitamins)
3. Play a game about healthy foods.
4. Make a healthy foods chart.

Supporting Answers

1. A good book is *Let's Eat: What Children Eat Around the World* by Beatrice Hollyer (Henry Holt, 2004) or a book of your choice
2. Ahead of time, consult such international health organizations as WHO (who.int) and UNICEF (unicef.org), and UN Food and Agriculture Organization (fao.org). Research what kinds and quantities of food children should be consuming to be considered healthy. In some cultures, obesity is a problem, while in other regions poverty and malnutrition are more of concern. Be sensitive to the needs and background of the children and parents in your group as you lead this award.

Some general information about food includes:

Proteins

You probably know you need to eat protein, but what is it? Many foods contain protein (say: pro-teen), but the best sources are beef, poultry, fish, eggs, dairy products, nuts, seeds, and legumes like black beans and lentils. Protein builds, maintains, and replaces the tissues in your body. (Not the tissues you blow your nose in! We mean the stuff your bodies made up of.) Your muscles, your organs, and your immune system are made up mostly of protein.

Vitamins

Vitamins and minerals are substances that are found in foods we eat. Your body needs them to work properly, so you grow and develop just like you should. When it comes to vitamins, each one has a special role to play. For example: Vitamin D in milk helps your bones. Vitamin A in carrots helps you see at night. Vitamin C in oranges helps your body heal if you get a cut. B vitamins in leafy green vegetables help your body make protein and energy.

Minerals

Just like vitamins, minerals help your body grow, develop, and stay healthy. The body uses minerals to perform many different functions — from building strong bones to transmitting nerve impulses. Some minerals are even used to make hormones or maintain a normal heartbeat.

3. Work with either real foods or with pictures/sketches/clipart of healthy foods like those they have learned about in this award.